

# Chapter 2, Section 1

James Lee

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1. Let  $A$  be an Abelian group, and define the *constant presheaf* associated to  $A$  on the topological space  $X$  to be the presheaf  $\mathcal{U} \mapsto A$  for all  $\mathcal{U} \neq \emptyset$ , with restriction maps the identity. Show that the constant sheaf  $\mathcal{A}$  defined in the text is the sheaf associated to this presheaf.

*Proof.* Let  $\mathcal{C}^+$  be the sheaf associated to the constant presheaf  $\mathcal{C}$  defined above. It suffices to show  $\mathcal{C}^+$  and  $\mathcal{A}$  are isomorphic at the level of stalks. Fix  $P \in X$ , then the stalk of  $\mathcal{C}^+$  at  $P$  is the same as the stalk of  $\mathcal{C}$  at  $P$ , and since the restriction morphisms of  $\mathcal{C}$  are identity maps, we must have  $\mathcal{C}_P^+ = \mathcal{C}_P = A$ . The constant sheaf  $\mathcal{A}$  is defined as  $\mathcal{U} \mapsto \{\text{continuous maps } \mathcal{U} \rightarrow A\}$ , where  $A$  has the discrete topology. Then, we can take the stalk of  $\mathcal{A}$  at  $x$  to be the direct limit of  $\mathcal{A}(\mathcal{U})$  where  $\mathcal{U}$  is a connected open neighborhood of  $x$ , and if  $\mathcal{U}$  is connected,  $\mathcal{A}(\mathcal{U}) = A$  since the image of a connected set must be connected, i.e.  $\mathcal{U} \rightarrow A$  is continuous if and only if it is constant. Therefore, we have  $\mathcal{A}_P = A$ . Hence,  $\mathcal{A}^+$  and  $\mathcal{A}$  are isomorphic.  $\square$

2. (a) For any morphism of sheaves  $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ , show that for each point  $P$ ,  $(\ker \varphi)_P = \ker(\varphi_P)$  and  $(\operatorname{im} \varphi)_P = \operatorname{im}(\varphi_P)$ .  
 (b) Show that  $\varphi$  is injective (respectively, surjective) if and only if the induced maps on the stalks  $\varphi_P$  is injective (respectively, surjective) for all  $P$ .  
 (c) Show that a sequence  $\dots \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{i-1} \xrightarrow{\varphi^{i-1}} \mathcal{F}^i \xrightarrow{\varphi^i} \mathcal{F}^{i+1} \rightarrow \dots$  of sheaves and morphisms is exact if and only if for each  $P \in X$  the corresponding sequence of stalks is exact as a sequence of abelian groups.

*Proof.*

- (a) It is true in general that kernels commute with limits and cokernels commute with colimits in any abelian category, since kernels and cokernels can be realized as limits and colimits, respectively.  
 (b)  $\varphi$  is injective  $\iff \ker \varphi = 0 \iff (\ker \varphi)_P = 0 \iff \ker \varphi_P = 0$ .  
 $\varphi$  is surjective  $\iff \operatorname{im} \varphi = \mathcal{G} \iff \operatorname{im}(\varphi_P) = (\operatorname{im} \varphi)_P = \mathcal{G}_P$ .  
 (c) The sequence  $\dots \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{i-1} \xrightarrow{\varphi^{i-1}} \mathcal{F}^i \xrightarrow{\varphi^i} \mathcal{F}^{i+1} \rightarrow \dots$  is exact  $\iff \operatorname{im} \varphi^{i-1} = \ker \varphi^i$  for all  $i \iff (\operatorname{im} \varphi^{i-1})_P = (\ker \varphi^i)_P$  for all  $i$  and  $P \in X \iff \operatorname{im}(\varphi_P^{i-1}) = \ker(\varphi_P^i)$  for all  $i$  and  $P \in X$  by part (a) above.

$\square$

3. (a) Let  $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  be a morphism of sheaves on  $X$ . Show that  $\varphi$  is surjective if and only if the following condition holds: for every open set  $\mathcal{U} \subseteq X$ , and for every  $s \in \mathcal{G}(\mathcal{U})$ , there is a covering  $\{\mathcal{U}_i\}$  of  $\mathcal{U}$ , and there are elements  $t_i \in \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{U}_i)$ , such that  $\varphi(t_i) = s|_{\mathcal{U}_i}$  for all  $i$ .  
 (b) Give an example of a surjective morphism of sheaves  $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$ , and an open set  $\mathcal{U}$  such that  $\varphi(\mathcal{U}) : \mathcal{F}(\mathcal{U}) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(\mathcal{U})$  is not surjective.

*Proof.*

- (a) Suppose  $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  is a surjective morphism of sheaves. Then for any  $P \in \mathcal{U}$ , the induced morphism of stalks  $\varphi_P : \mathcal{F}_P \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_P$  is surjective. The elements of  $\mathcal{G}_P$  (and similarly  $\mathcal{F}_P$ ) are an equivalence class of ordered pairs  $(\mathcal{U}, s)$  with  $\mathcal{U}$  an open neighborhood of  $P$  and  $s \in \mathcal{G}(\mathcal{U})$  and the equivalence relation  $(\mathcal{U}, s) \sim (\mathcal{V}, t)$  if and only if there exists some open  $W \subseteq \mathcal{U} \cap \mathcal{V}$  containing  $P$

such that  $s|_W = t|_W$ . If  $\varphi_P$  is surjective, then for every  $(U, s) \in \mathcal{G}_P$  there exists some  $(V, f) \in \mathcal{G}_P$  such that

$$\varphi_P(V, f) = (V, \varphi f), \quad \varphi : \mathcal{F}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(V),$$

so there exists some open subset  $W \subseteq U \cap V$  such that  $\varphi f|_W = s|_W$ . We can repeat this process for all  $x \in U$  to obtain an open cover with the desired properties, that is  $\{W_x\}_{x \in U}$  of  $U$  where  $W_x$  is defined as above with an associated  $f_x \in \mathcal{F}(W_x)$  such that by definition  $\varphi f_x = s|_{W_x}$ .

Conversely, it suffices to show  $\varphi_P : \mathcal{F}_P \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_P$  is surjective for all  $P \in X$ . Fix  $P \in X$  and consider an arbitrary element  $(U, s) \in \mathcal{F}_P$ . We want to show there exists some  $(V, f) \in \mathcal{G}_P$  such that  $(V, \varphi_P(f)) \sim (U, s)$ . To that end, by assumption there exists some open subset  $W \subseteq U$  and  $g \in \mathcal{F}(W)$  such that  $\varphi_W(g) = s|_W$ , hence  $\varphi_P(W, g) = (U, s)$ .

- (b) We provide an example of a sheaf from open sets to sets that satisfies the condition. Let  $X, Y = S^1$ . Let  $\pi_X : X \rightarrow S^1$  be the identity map, and let  $\tau : Y \rightarrow X$  be defined by  $z \mapsto z^2$  where  $X, Y$  is identified with the unit circle in the complex plane, and let  $\pi_Y := \tau \circ \pi_X$ . Define a sheaf  $\mathcal{F}$  on  $S^1$  for a nonempty open subset  $U$  of  $S^1$  as

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{F}(U) &= \{\text{sections } s : U \rightarrow X \text{ with respect to } \pi_X\} \\ &= \{\text{continuous maps } s : U \rightarrow X \text{ such that } \pi_X \circ s = \text{id}_U\}, \end{aligned}$$

and similarly define  $\mathcal{G}$  as the map that maps  $U$  to the set of sections from  $U$  to  $Y$  with respect to  $\pi_Y$ . If  $s \in \mathcal{G}(U)$  so that  $\pi_Y \circ s = \text{id}_U$ , then we can compose  $s$  with  $\tau$  so that

$$\pi_X \circ (\tau \circ s) = (\pi_X \circ \tau) \circ s = \pi_Y \circ s = \text{id}_U,$$

which shows  $\tau \circ s$  is a section from  $U$  to  $X$ , so we can define a morphism  $\tau_{\#} : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$  induced by  $\tau$  as

$$\begin{aligned} \tau_{\#}(U) : \mathcal{G}(U) &\rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U) \\ s &\mapsto \tau \circ s. \end{aligned}$$

Let  $U$  be the entire space  $S^1$ , then  $\mathcal{G}(S^1) = \emptyset$  and  $\mathcal{F}(S^1) = \{\text{id} : S^1 \rightarrow X\}$ , so  $\mathcal{G}(S^1) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(S^1)$  cannot be surjective. However, for any proper open subset  $U$  of  $S^1$ , the map  $\tau_{\#} : \mathcal{G}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)$  is surjective, thus by part (a) above  $\tau_{\#}$  is a surjective morphism. □

5. Show that a morphism of sheaves is an isomorphism if and only if it is both injective and surjective.

*Proof.*  $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  is an isomorphism  $\iff \varphi_P : \mathcal{F}_P \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_P$  is an isomorphism for all  $P \in X \iff \varphi$  is injective and surjective by Exercise 2. □

6. (a) Let  $\mathcal{F}'$  be a subsheaf of a sheaf  $\mathcal{F}$ . Show that the natural map of  $\mathcal{F}$  to the quotient sheaf  $\mathcal{F}/\mathcal{F}'$  is surjective, and has kernel  $\mathcal{F}'$ . Thus, there is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{F} \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}/\mathcal{F}' \longrightarrow 0.$$

- (b) Conversely, if  $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{F}' \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}'' \rightarrow 0$  is an exact sequence, show that  $\mathcal{F}'$  is isomorphic to a subsheaf of  $\mathcal{F}$ , and that  $\mathcal{F}''$  is isomorphic to the quotient  $\mathcal{F}$  by this subsheaf.

*Proof.*

- (a) The map  $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)/\mathcal{F}'(U)$  is surjective for all open  $U \subseteq X$ , so  $\pi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}/\mathcal{F}'$  is surjective. To show  $\pi$  has kernel  $\mathcal{F}'$ , by Exercise 2 it suffices to show  $(\ker \pi)_P = \mathcal{F}'_P$  for all  $P \in X$ . Each map  $\mathcal{F}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U)/\mathcal{F}'(U)$  has kernel  $\mathcal{F}'(U)$ , hence we have  $(\ker \pi)_P = \varinjlim \mathcal{F}'(U) = \mathcal{F}'_P$ .
- (b) By Exercise 2, We have the following equivalent statements:

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \rightarrow \mathcal{F}' \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}'' \rightarrow 0 &\text{ is exact.} \\ \iff 0 \rightarrow \mathcal{F}'_P \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_P \rightarrow \mathcal{F}''_P \rightarrow 0 &\text{ is exact.} \\ \iff \mathcal{F}'_P \subseteq \mathcal{F}_P \text{ and } \mathcal{F}''_P \simeq \mathcal{F}_P/\mathcal{F}'_P \simeq (\mathcal{F}/\mathcal{F}')_P & \\ \iff \mathcal{F}' \text{ is isomorphic to a subsheaf of } \mathcal{F} \text{ and } \mathcal{F}'' \cong \mathcal{F}/\mathcal{F}'. & \end{aligned}$$

□

7. Let  $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  be a morphism of sheaves.

- (a) Show that  $\text{im } \varphi \cong \mathcal{F} / \ker \varphi$ .
- (b) Show that  $\text{coker } \varphi \cong \mathcal{G} / \text{im } \varphi$ .

*Proof.*

- (a) It suffices to show  $(\text{im } \varphi)_P \simeq \mathcal{F}_P / (\ker \varphi)_P$ , which again follows from the fact that for all open  $U \subseteq X$ ,  $\text{im } (\varphi(U)) \simeq \mathcal{F}(U) / \ker (\varphi(U))$ .
- (b) In the same vain,  $\text{coker } \varphi \simeq \mathcal{G} / \text{im } \varphi$  follows from the fact that  $\text{coker } (\varphi(U)) \simeq \mathcal{G}(U) / \text{im } (\varphi(U))$ .

□

8. For any open subset  $U \subseteq X$ , show that the functor  $\Gamma(U, \cdot)$  from sheaves on  $X$  to abelian groups is a left exact functor, i.e. if  $0 \rightarrow \mathcal{F}' \xrightarrow{f} \mathcal{F} \xrightarrow{g} \mathcal{F}''$  is an exact sequence of sheaves, then  $0 \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}') \xrightarrow{f_U} \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}) \xrightarrow{g_U} \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}'')$  is an exact sequence of groups.

*Proof.* Exactness at  $\Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}')$  follows from the fact that  $\mathcal{F}' \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$  is an injective morphism of sheaves if and only if  $\Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}') \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F})$  is injective for all  $U$ . To show exactness at  $\Gamma(U, \mathcal{F})$ , the sequence  $\mathcal{F}' \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}''$  is exact if and only if  $\mathcal{F}'_P \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_P \rightarrow \mathcal{F}''_P$  is an exact sequence for all  $P \in X$ .

If  $s \in \text{im } f_U$  then  $(U, s) \in \ker g_P$  for all  $P \in X$ , so  $(U, g(s))$  equals to 0 everywhere locally, hence  $s \in g_U$ . Conversely, if  $s \in \ker g_U$ , then by Exercise 3 there exists an open cover  $\{U_i\}$  and elements  $t_i \in \Gamma(U_i, \mathcal{F}')$  such that  $f_U(t_i) = s|_{U_i}$ . For any  $i, j$ , consider  $t_i|_{U_i \cap U_j}, t_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ . Since  $f_{U_i \cap U_j} : \Gamma(U_i \cap U_j, \mathcal{F}') \rightarrow \Gamma(U_i \cap U_j, \mathcal{F})$  is injective and  $f_{U_i \cap U_j}(t_i|_{U_i \cap U_j}) = f_{U_i \cap U_j}(t_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}) = s|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ , we have must  $t_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = t_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ , so by the sheaf property there exists  $t \in \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}')$  such that  $t|_{U_i} = t_i$ , so  $f_U(t) = s$ , hence  $s \in \text{im } f_U$ . □

9. *Direct Sum.* Let  $\mathcal{F}$  and  $\mathcal{G}$  be sheaves on  $X$ . Show that the presheaf  $U \mapsto \mathcal{F}(U) \oplus \mathcal{G}(U)$  is a sheaf. It is called the *direct sum* of  $\mathcal{F}$  and  $\mathcal{G}$ , and is denoted by  $\mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G}$ . Show that it plays the role of direct sum and of direct product in the category of sheaves of abelian groups.

*Proof.* Since the category of sheaves on  $X$  is a full subcategory of presheaves on  $X$ , it suffices to show it satisfies the universal property of a direct sum and of direct product in the category of presheaves of abelian groups on  $X$ , then show it satisfies the sheaf property. Let  $\pi_1 : \mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ ,  $\pi_2 : \mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  be the canonical projection morphisms, and let  $\mathcal{H} \in \mathfrak{PrcSh}_X$  with morphisms  $\tau_1 : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$  and  $\tau_2 : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 \mathcal{H} & \xrightarrow{\tau_2} & \mathcal{G} \\
 \searrow \alpha & \searrow \pi_2 & \\
 \mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G} & \xrightarrow{\pi_2} & \mathcal{G} \\
 \downarrow \pi_1 & & \\
 \mathcal{F} & & 
 \end{array}$$

(Note: The diagram also includes a curved arrow from  $\mathcal{H}$  to  $\mathcal{F}$  labeled  $\tau_1$ .)

we find the find a unique morphism  $\alpha : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G}$  such that the diagram above commutes. For any open  $U \subseteq X$ , define  $\alpha(U) : \mathcal{H}(U) \rightarrow (\mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G})(U)$  as  $\alpha(h) = (\tau_1(h), \tau_2(h))$ . Since  $\alpha(U)$  is unique by the same universal property for abelian groups,  $\alpha$  must be the desired unique morphism, and since the direct sum and direct product are essentially the same for finite collections, we have shown  $\mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G}$  is a direct sum and product in the category of presheaves.

Now we show  $\mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G}$  is a sheaf. Let  $U$  be an open subset of  $X$ , and let  $\{V_i\}$  be a cover of  $U$  by open sets. If  $(s, t) \in \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G})$ , then  $(s|_{U_i}, t|_{U_i}) = (s, t)|_{U_i} = 0$  by universal property nonsense, so  $s = 0$  and  $t = 0$ . Also, if we have elements  $(s_i, t_i) \in \Gamma(V_i, \mathcal{F} \oplus \mathcal{G})$  such that for all  $i, j$ ,  $(s_i, t_i)|_{V_i \cap V_j} = (s_j, t_j)|_{V_i \cap V_j}$ , then again  $(s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j}, t_i|_{U_i \cap U_j}) = (s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}, t_j|_{U_i \cap U_j})$  if and only if  $s_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = s_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$  and  $t_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} = t_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$ , so by the sheaf properties of  $\mathcal{F}$  and  $\mathcal{G}$ , there exists  $s \in \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F})$  and  $t \in \Gamma(U, \mathcal{G})$  such that  $(s, t)|_{U_i} = (s_i, t_i)$ . □

- 10. Direct Limit.** Let  $\{\mathcal{F}_i\}$  be a direct system of sheaves and morphisms on  $X$ . We define the *direct limit* of the system  $\{\mathcal{F}_i\}$ , denoted  $\varinjlim \mathcal{F}_i$ , to be the sheaf associated to the presheaf  $U \mapsto \varinjlim \mathcal{F}_i(U)$ . Show that this is a direct limit in the category of sheaves on  $X$ .

*Proof.* Let  $\mathcal{F}$  denote the presheaf defined  $U \mapsto \varinjlim \mathcal{F}_i$ , and let  $\mathcal{F}^+$  denote the sheaf associated to  $\mathcal{F}$  with associated morphism  $\theta : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^+$ . From the direct system, we have morphisms  $\mu_{ij} : \mathcal{F}_i \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_j$  and  $\mu_i : \mathcal{F}_i \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$  such that for all  $i, j$ ,  $\mu_i = \mu_j \circ \mu_{ij}$ . To show  $\mathcal{F}^+$  is a direct limit in the category-theoretic sense, we must provide the data of morphisms (between sheaves)  $\alpha_i : \mathcal{F}_i \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^+$  such that  $\alpha_i = \alpha_j \circ \mu_{ij}$  for all  $i, j$  satisfying the following universal property: if  $\mathcal{G}$  is any sheaf on  $X$  with the data of morphisms  $\{\phi_i : \mathcal{F}_i \rightarrow \mathcal{G}\}$  satisfying for all  $i, j$ ,  $\phi_i = \phi_j \circ \mu_{ij}$ , then there exists a unique morphism  $\phi : \mathcal{F}^+ \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  such that  $\phi_i = \phi \circ \alpha_i$ . Observe the following commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 & & \phi_i & & \\
 & \nearrow & & \searrow & \\
 \mathcal{F}_i & \xrightarrow{\mu_i} & \mathcal{F} & \xrightarrow{\psi} & \mathcal{G} \\
 & \searrow & \downarrow \theta & \nearrow & \\
 & & \mathcal{F}^+ & & 
 \end{array}$$

$\alpha_i := \theta \circ \mu_i$

We claim  $\{\alpha_i := \theta \circ \mu_i\}$  are the desired morphisms. By the universal property of the direct limit which defines  $\mathcal{F}$  and the direct system of morphisms  $\{\mu_i\}$ , there exists a unique morphism between presheaves  $\psi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  such that  $\phi_i = \psi \circ \mu_i$ . Then, by the universal property of the sheaf  $\mathcal{F}^+$  associated to the presheaf  $\mathcal{F}$ , there exists a unique morphism between sheaves  $\phi : \mathcal{F}^+ \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  such that  $\psi = \phi \circ \theta$ . It remains to check  $\phi_i = \phi \circ \alpha_i$ . Indeed, we have

$$\phi_i = \psi \circ \mu_i = (\phi \circ \theta) \circ \mu_i = \phi \circ (\theta \circ \mu_i) = \phi \circ \alpha_i,$$

and  $\phi$  is unique by the universal properties above.  $\square$

- 11.** Let  $\{\mathcal{F}_i\}$  be a direct system of sheaves on a noetherian topological space  $X$ . In this case show that the presheaf  $U \mapsto \varinjlim \mathcal{F}_i(U)$  is already a sheaf. In particular,  $\Gamma(X, \varinjlim \mathcal{F}_i) = \varinjlim \Gamma(X, \mathcal{F}_i)$ .

*Proof.* We directly show the presheaf  $\mathcal{F}$  defined by  $\mathcal{F}(U) = \varinjlim \mathcal{F}_i(U)$  is a sheaf. Let  $U$  be an open subset of  $X$ , and let  $\{V_i\}$  be open cover of  $U$ . By the noetherian hypothesis, we can assume  $\{V_j\}$  to be a finite set ( $1 \leq j \leq n$ ), then we have the following exact sequence of abelian groups

$$0 \longrightarrow \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{j=1}^n \Gamma(V_j, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{j,k} \Gamma(V_j \cap V_k, \mathcal{F}_i),$$

and since both products  $\prod_{j=1}^n \Gamma(V_j, \mathcal{F}_i)$  and  $\prod_{j \neq k} \Gamma(V_j \cap V_k, \mathcal{F}_i)$  are finite, it is equivalent to the coproduct; in particular, colimits commute with colimits, so we have the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \varinjlim \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{j=1}^n \varinjlim \Gamma(V_j, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{j,k} \varinjlim \Gamma(V_j \cap V_k, \mathcal{F}_i)$$

so the sheaf properties immediately follow.  $\square$

- 12. Inverse Limit.** Let  $\{\mathcal{F}_i\}$  be an inverse system of sheaves on  $X$ . Show that the presheaf  $U \mapsto \varprojlim \mathcal{F}_i(U)$  is a sheaf. It is called the *inverse limit* of the system  $\{\mathcal{F}_i\}$ , and is denoted by  $\varprojlim \mathcal{F}_i$ . Show that this it has the universal property of an inverse limit in the category of sheaves.

*Proof.* Let  $\mathcal{F}$  be the presheaf  $U \mapsto \varprojlim \mathcal{F}_i(U)$ . We have morphisms  $\pi_{ij} : \mathcal{F}_i \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_j$  and  $\pi_i : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_i$  such that for all  $i, j$ ,  $\pi_j = \pi_{ij} \circ \pi_i$ . If  $U$  is an open set, if  $\{V_\alpha\}$  is an open covering of  $U$ , then we have the exact sequence of abelian groups

$$0 \longrightarrow \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_\alpha \Gamma(V_\alpha, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{\alpha, \beta} \Gamma(V_\alpha \cap V_\beta, \mathcal{F}_i)$$

and direct limits commute with direct products, so the fact that  $\mathcal{F}$  is a sheaf follows from the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \varprojlim \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_\alpha \varprojlim \Gamma(V_\alpha, \mathcal{F}_i) \longrightarrow \prod_{\alpha, \beta} \varprojlim \Gamma(V_\alpha \cap V_\beta, \mathcal{F}_i).$$

To show  $\mathcal{F}$  is an inverse limit in a category-theoretic sense, if  $\mathcal{G}$  is some sheaf on  $X$  with a collection of morphisms  $\tau_i : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}_i$  such that  $\tau_j = \pi_{ij} \circ \tau_i$  for all  $i, j$ , then we want to show there exists a unique  $\theta : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$  such that  $\tau_i = \pi_i \circ \theta$ . Since for each open subset  $U$  in  $X$  we have a direct system  $\tau_i(U) : \Gamma(U, \mathcal{G}) \rightarrow \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}_i)$ , by the universal property of the inverse limit  $\Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}) = \varprojlim \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}_i)$ , there exists a unique morphism  $\theta(U) : \Gamma(U, \mathcal{G}) \rightarrow \varprojlim \Gamma(U, \mathcal{F}_i)$  such that  $\tau_i(U) = \pi_i(U) \circ \theta(U)$ , so we can define  $\theta$  as such, then it is unique by construction.  $\square$

- 14. Support.** Let  $\mathcal{F}$  be a sheaf on  $X$ , and let  $s \in \mathcal{F}(U)$  be a section over an open set  $U$ . The *support* of  $s$ , denoted  $\text{Supp } s$ , is defined to be  $\{P \in U \mid s_P \neq 0\}$ , where  $s_P$  denotes the germ of  $s$  in the stalk  $\mathcal{F}_P$ . Show that  $\text{Supp } s$  is a closed subset of  $U$ . We define the *support* of  $\mathcal{F}$ ,  $\text{Supp } \mathcal{F}$ , to be  $\{P \in X \mid \mathcal{F}_P \neq 0\}$ . It need not be a closed subset.

*Proof.* We show  $U - \text{Supp } s$  is an open set. If  $Q \in U$  such that  $s_Q = 0$ , then by definition of the direct limit, there exists an open neighborhood  $V$  of  $Q$  in  $U$  such that  $0 = (V, s|_V) \in \mathcal{F}_Q$ , hence  $s_R = 0$  for all  $R \in V$ .  $\square$

- 15. Sheaf  $\mathcal{H}\text{om}$ .** Let  $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G}$  be sheaves of abelian groups on  $X$ . For any open subset  $U \subseteq X$ , show that the set  $\text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U)$  of morphisms of the restricted sheaves has a natural structure of an abelian group. Show that the presheaf  $U \mapsto \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U)$  is a sheaf. It is called the *sheaf of local morphisms* of  $\mathcal{F}$  into  $\mathcal{G}$ , "sheaf hom" for short, and is denoted  $\mathcal{H}\text{om}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$ .

*Proof.* Morphisms  $f, g \in \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U)$  define for all open  $V \subseteq U$  homomorphisms between abelian groups  $f(V), g(V) : \mathcal{F}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{G}(V)$ , so we can define  $f + g$  as  $(f + g)(V) = f(V) + g(V)$ . It is obviously an abelian group with identity  $0$  as the zero morphism defined by  $0(V) \equiv 0$ .

Let  $U$  be an open subset of  $X$ , and let  $\{V_i\}$  be an open cover of  $U$ . We make some clarifying remarks. If  $s \in \Gamma(U, \mathcal{H}\text{om}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})) = \text{Hom}(\mathcal{F}|_U, \mathcal{G}|_U)$ , then  $s$  is a natural transformation of functors  $\mathcal{F}|_U \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_U$ , so  $s|_{V_i}$  refers to the induced natural transformation of functors  $\mathcal{F}|_{V_i} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}|_{V_i}$  by only considering open subsets  $W \subseteq V_i$ . Thus, we have the following commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \Gamma(W, \mathcal{F}) & \longrightarrow & \prod \Gamma(W \cap V_i, \mathcal{F}) & \longrightarrow & \prod \Gamma(W \cap V_i \cap V_j, \mathcal{F}) \\ & & s(W) \downarrow & & \prod s(W \cap V_i) \downarrow & & \prod s(W \cap V_i \cap V_j) \downarrow \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \Gamma(W, \mathcal{G}) & \longrightarrow & \prod \Gamma(W \cap V_i, \mathcal{G}) & \longrightarrow & \prod \Gamma(W \cap V_i \cap V_j, \mathcal{G}) \end{array}$$

hence  $\mathcal{H}\text{om}(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$  is a sheaf.  $\square$

- 17. Skyscraper Sheaves.** Let  $X$  be a topological space, let  $P$  be a point, and let  $A$  be an abelian group. Define a sheaf  $i_P(A)$  on  $X$  as follows:  $i_P(A)(U) = A$  if  $P \in U$ ,  $0$  otherwise. Verify that the stalk of  $i_P(A)$  is  $A$  at every point  $Q \in \overline{\{P\}}$ , and  $0$  elsewhere. Hence, the name "Skyscraper sheaf." Show that this sheaf could also be described as  $i_*(A)$ , where  $A$  denotes the constant sheaf  $A$  on the closed subspace  $\overline{\{P\}}$ , and  $i : \overline{\{P\}} \rightarrow X$  is the inclusion.

*Proof.* We first identify the restriction maps of  $i_P(A)$ . Let  $U \subseteq V$  be open subsets of  $X$ , then  $i_P(A)(V) \rightarrow i_P(A)(U)$  is the zero map if either  $V$  or  $U$  (hence  $V$  as well) does not contain  $P$ , and is the identity map if both  $V$  and  $U$  contain  $P$ . If  $Q \in \overline{\{P\}}$ , then every open neighborhood of  $Q$  contains  $P$ , so the direct system of open neighborhoods of  $Q$  induces the direct system consisting of a copy of  $A$  for every  $U \ni Q$  with the identity map as transition maps, hence  $(i_P(A))_Q = A$ . If  $Q \notin \overline{\{P\}}$ , then there exists an open neighborhood  $W$  of  $Q$  not containing  $P$ , which means  $i_P(A)(W) = 0$ , hence  $(i_P(A))_Q = 0$ . The last statement is obvious.  $\square$

- 18. Adjoint Property of  $f^{-1}$ .** Let  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  be a continuous map of topological spaces. Show that for any sheaf  $\mathcal{F}$  on  $X$  there is a natural map  $f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ , and for any sheaf  $\mathcal{G}$  on  $Y$  there is a natural map  $\mathcal{G} \rightarrow f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G}$ . Use these maps to show that there is a natural bijection of sets, for any sheaves  $\mathcal{F}$  on  $X$  and  $\mathcal{G}$  on  $Y$ ,

$$\text{Hom}_X(f^{-1}\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{F}) = \text{Hom}_Y(\mathcal{G}, f_*\mathcal{F}).$$

*Proof.* Let  $U, V$  be open in  $X, Y$ , respectively. We unpack the definitions:

$$\begin{aligned}(f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F})(U) &= \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(U)} (f_*\mathcal{F})(W) = \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(U)} \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(W)), \\ (f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(V) &= (f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(f^{-1}(V)) = \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(f^{-1}(V))} \mathcal{G}(W).\end{aligned}$$

We also have

$$\begin{aligned}(f_*f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F})(V) &= (f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F})(f^{-1}(V)) \\ &= \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(f^{-1}(V))} \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(W)) \\ &= \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(V)) \\ &= (f_*\mathcal{F})(V) \\ (f^{-1}f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(U) &= \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(U)} (f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(W) \\ &= \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(U)} \varinjlim_{W' \supseteq f(f^{-1}(W))} \mathcal{G}(W') \\ &= \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(U)} \mathcal{G}(W) \\ &= (f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(U)\end{aligned}$$

Note that  $V' := f(f^{-1}(V)) = V \cap f(X)$ . An element of  $(f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F})(U)$  is of the form  $(W, s)$  where  $W \supseteq f(U)$  and  $s \in \mathcal{F}(f^{-1}(W))$ . Define  $\alpha : f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$  as

$$\begin{aligned}\alpha(U) : (f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F})(U) &\rightarrow \mathcal{F}(U) \\ (W, s) &\mapsto s|_U.\end{aligned}$$

An element of  $(f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(V)$  is of the form  $(W, t)$  where  $W \supseteq V'$  and  $t \in \mathcal{G}(W)$ . Define  $\beta : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G}$  as

$$\begin{aligned}\beta(V) : \mathcal{G}(V) &\rightarrow (f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G})(V) \\ t &\mapsto (V, t).\end{aligned}$$

Let  $\varphi : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}'$ ,  $\psi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}'$ , where  $\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{F}' \in \mathfrak{Sh}_X$ ,  $\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{G}' \in \mathfrak{Sh}_Y$ ,  $\varphi \in \text{Hom}_X(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{F}')$ , and  $\psi \in \text{Hom}_Y(\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{G}')$ . We explicitly describe the induced lifts with respect to  $f$ , namely  $f_*\varphi : f_*\mathcal{F} \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{F}'$  and  $f^{-1}\psi : f^{-1}\mathcal{G} \rightarrow f^{-1}\mathcal{G}'$ . Let  $U, V$  be open sets in  $X, Y$ , respectively. Define

$$\begin{aligned}f_*\varphi(V) : f_*\mathcal{F}(V) &\rightarrow f_*\mathcal{F}'(V) \\ s &\mapsto \varphi(f^{-1}(V))(s)\end{aligned}$$

where  $s \in \Gamma(f^{-1}(V), \mathcal{F})$ , and define

$$\begin{aligned}f^{-1}\psi(U) : f^{-1}\mathcal{G}(U) &\rightarrow f^{-1}\mathcal{G}'(U) \\ (W, t) &\mapsto (W, \psi(W)(t)),\end{aligned}$$

where  $(W, t) \in \varinjlim_{W \supseteq f(U)} \mathcal{G}(W)$ . For every  $\varphi : f^{-1}\mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$ , we have the morphism  $f_*\varphi : f_*f^{-1}\mathcal{G} \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{F}$ , so we define  $\beta^* : \text{Hom}_X(f^{-1}\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{F}) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_Y(\mathcal{G}, f_*\mathcal{F})$  as

$$\beta^*\varphi = (f_*\varphi) \circ \beta.$$

Similarly, for every  $\psi : \mathcal{G} \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{F}$ , we have the morphism  $f^{-1}\psi : f^{-1}\mathcal{G} \rightarrow f^{-1}f_*\mathcal{F}$ , so we define  $\alpha_* : \text{Hom}_Y(\mathcal{G}, f_*\mathcal{F}) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_X(f^{-1}\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{F})$  as

$$\alpha_*\psi = \alpha \circ (f^{-1}\psi).$$

To show  $\alpha_*, \beta^*$  are bijections with inverses to each other, it suffices to show  $\alpha_* \circ \beta^* = \text{id}_{\text{Hom}_X(f^{-1}\mathcal{G}, \mathcal{F})}$  and  $\beta^* \circ \alpha_* = \text{id}_{\text{Hom}_Y(\mathcal{G} \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{F})}$ :

$$(\alpha_* \circ \beta^*)(\varphi) = \alpha_*((f_*\varphi) \circ \beta) = \alpha \circ f^{-1}((f_*\varphi) \circ \beta) = \alpha \circ (f^{-1}f_*\varphi) \circ (f^{-1}\beta)$$

$$(\beta^* \circ \alpha^*)(\psi) = \beta^*(\alpha \circ (f^{-1}\psi)) = f_*(\alpha \circ (f^{-1}\psi)) \circ \beta = (f_*\alpha) \circ (f_*f^{-1}\psi) \circ \beta.$$

Again, we unpack the definitions. Let  $(W, s) \in f^{-1}\mathcal{G}(\mathcal{U})$ , where  $f(\mathcal{U}) \subseteq W \subseteq Y$  with  $t \in \Gamma(W, \mathcal{G})$ . We want to show

$$(\alpha_*\beta^*\varphi)(\mathcal{U})((W, t)) = \varphi(\mathcal{U})((W, t)).$$

We have

$$\begin{aligned} (\alpha_*\beta^*\varphi)(\mathcal{U})((W, t)) &= (\alpha(\mathcal{U}) \circ (f^{-1}f_*\varphi))(\mathcal{U}) \circ (f^{-1}\beta)(\mathcal{U})((W, t)) \\ &= (\alpha(\mathcal{U}) \circ (f^{-1}f_*\varphi)(\mathcal{U}))((W, t)) \\ &= \alpha(\mathcal{U})((f^{-1}(W), \varphi(f^{-1}(W))(t))) \\ &= \varphi(f^{-1}(W))((W, t))|_{\mathcal{U}} \\ &= \varphi(\mathcal{U})((W, t)). \end{aligned}$$

Here, we used the fact that the restriction map commutes with  $\varphi(\mathcal{U})$  by definition of morphisms between sheaves. Let  $t \in \Gamma(V, \mathcal{G})$ . We similarly have

$$\begin{aligned} (\beta_*\alpha^*\psi)(V)(t) &= ((f_*\alpha)(V) \circ (f_*f^{-1}\psi)(V) \circ \beta(V))(t) \\ &= ((f_*\alpha)(V) \circ (f_*f^{-1}\psi(V)))((V, t)) \\ &= (f_*\alpha)(V)(\psi(V)(t)) \\ &= \psi(V)(t). \end{aligned}$$

Hence,  $\alpha_*$  and  $\beta^*$  are bijections with inverses to each other. □

**22. Glueing Sheaves.** Let  $X$  be a topological space, let  $\mathcal{U} = \{U_i\}$  be an open cover of  $X$ , and suppose we are given for each  $i$  a sheaf  $\mathcal{F}_i$  on  $U_i$ , and for each  $i, j$  an isomorphism  $\varphi_{ij} : \mathcal{F}_i|_{U_i \cap U_j} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{F}_j|_{U_i \cap U_j}$  such that

- (1) for each  $i$ ,  $\varphi_{ii} = \text{id}$ ,
- (2) and for each  $i, j, k$ ,  $\varphi_{ik} = \varphi_{jk} \circ \varphi_{ij}$  on  $U_i \cap U_j \cap U_k$ .

Then there exists a unique sheaf  $\mathcal{F}$  on  $X$  together with isomorphisms  $\psi_i : \mathcal{F}|_{U_i} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{F}_i$  such that for each  $i, j$ ,  $\psi_j = \varphi_{ij} \circ \psi_i$  on  $U_i \cap U_j$ . We say loosely that  $\mathcal{F}$  is obtained by *glueing* the sheaves  $\mathcal{F}_i$  via the isomorphisms  $\varphi_{ij}$ .

**Shame on James for skipping this “standard exercise.”**